🔶 1. What is Ethics? Explain its scope.

Answer:

Ethics is the branch of philosophy that deals with what is right and what is wrong. It helps people understand how they should behave in personal life, in society, and in professional situations. Ethics guides human behavior based on values like honesty, justice, fairness, and responsibility.

The scope of ethics includes:

1. **PersonalEthics:**
   Personal ethics are based on an individual's own moral values. It helps people decide what is good or bad in their everyday life.

2. **SocialEthics:**
   Social ethics refers to the moral rules that guide society. It includes concepts like equality, justice, human rights, and the welfare of all people.

3. **ProfessionalEthics:**
   Professional ethics are the rules of right and wrong in the workplace. Professions like medicine, law, teaching, and business have their own ethical standards.

4. **EnvironmentalEthics:**
   Environmental ethics focuses on the relationship between humans and nature. It teaches us to protect natural resources and ensure sustainability.

5. **Bioethics:**
   Bioethics deals with moral questions in science and medicine. Topics include organ donation, euthanasia, cloning, and genetic engineering.

6. **NormativeEthics:**
   Normative ethics tries to find general rules or principles of right and wrong that everyone can follow.

7. **AppliedEthics:**
   Applied ethics uses ethical theories to solve real-life problems like war, abortion, animal rights, and capital punishment.

🔶 2. Distinguish between Ethics and Religion.

Answer:

Ethics and religion both talk about right and wrong, but they are not the same. They have different sources and purposes.

Point	Ethics	Religion
Based on	Human logic, reason, and social values	Faith, God, holy texts, and spiritual rules
Applies to	Everyone, even non-religious people	Only followers of that religion
Can change?	Yes, ethics can evolve with time	Religious rules usually stay the same
Goal	To make a fair and just society	To achieve spiritual connection with God
Controlled by	Laws, conscience, and public values	Religious leaders and beliefs
Belief in God needed	No	Yes, in most religions

In short, ethics is based on thinking and logic, while religion is based on faith and belief.

🔶 3. What is Hedonism in ethics?

Answer:

Hedonism is an ethical theory that says **pleasure is the highest good** in life. According to hedonism, an action is morally right if it increases pleasure or happiness and reduces pain. Anything that causes pain is considered bad.

There are two types of hedonism:

1. **Egoistic Hedonism:**
   This type focuses on one's **own personal pleasure**. If something makes you happy, it is good for you.
2. **Altruistic Hedonism:**
   This type focuses on the **happiness of others**, not just yourself. An action is good if it increases pleasure for as many people as possible.

Philosophers like **Epicurus** believed in simple living to find long-term happiness. Later, **John Stuart Mill** said that some pleasures (like knowledge, music, or love) are **higher** than physical pleasures (like eating or sleeping).

🔶 4. Explain Rationalism and Rigorism in ethics.

Answer:

Rationalism is the belief that people should use logic and reason to understand what is right or wrong. It says we should not blindly follow rules, but instead, think carefully and decide based on reason.

Rigorism, on the other hand, says that we must **strictly follow moral rules** without any exception. Even if the result is hard or painful, we should do what is morally right according to fixed laws.

In short:

- Rationalism = “Think to find the truth.”
- Rigorism = “Follow the rules, no matter what.”

🔶 5. Explain the idea of "Die to Live" in ethics.

Answer:

In ethics, the phrase "Die to live" means that sometimes we must **sacrifice** our comfort, needs, or even life to do what is morally right. It is often used to show that giving up something important can lead to a **higher good or a meaningful life**.

Examples include:

- A person sacrificing their life to protect others.
- A religious believer facing death instead of giving up their faith.
- A freedom fighter giving up life for their country.

So, this concept teaches that moral or spiritual growth sometimes comes from personal loss or sacrifice.

🔶 6. Explain the four ethical justifications for punishment.

Answer:

Punishment is used when someone does something morally or legally wrong. In ethics, there are four main reasons to justify punishment:

1. **RetributivePunishment:**
   The person **deserves** punishment for their wrong action. It is about justice, not revenge.
2. **DeterrentPunishment:**
   Punishment should work as a **warning** to stop others from doing the same thing.
3. **PreventivePunishment:**
   The aim is to **protect society** by stopping the wrongdoer from causing more harm.
4. **ReformativePunishment:**
   This type helps the wrongdoer **change and become a better person** in the future.

🔶 7. What is Meta-ethics?

Answer:

Meta-ethics is a branch of ethics that studies the **meaning and nature of moral language**. While normative ethics asks, “What is right or wrong?”, meta-ethics asks **deeper questions** like:

- What does "good" really mean?
- Are moral values real or just opinions?
- Can we know moral truth like we know science?

Meta-ethics does not give direct answers about actions. Instead, it helps us **understand the foundation of ethical ideas**. It studies where moral values come from, how we talk about them, and whether they are objective or subjective.

🔶 8. What is Emotivism? Explain A. J. Ayer's view.

Answer:

Emotivism is a meta-ethical theory which says that **moral statements are expressions of emotions**, not facts. According to this theory, when someone says, "Stealing is wrong," they are not stating a truth — they are simply **showing their emotional dislike** of stealing.

A. J. Ayer, a famous philosopher, believed that:

- Moral language like "murder is wrong" is equal to saying "Boo to murder!"
- Moral statements **cannot be proven true or false** because they are not based on facts.
- These statements are used to **influence others**, not to describe the world.
- Emotivism is part of **Logical Positivism**, which says that only science or logic can give us real knowledge.

In short, Ayer's emotivism treats moral statements like **emotional reactions**, not objective truths.

🔶 9. What is Non-naturalism in ethics?

Answer:

Non-naturalism is a theory in ethics that says **moral truths exist**, but they are **not part of the natural or scientific world**. This means we cannot see, touch, or test moral values in a laboratory.

For example:

- Saying "Kindness is good" is a true statement.
- But the "goodness" in kindness is not something you can measure — you **understand it through reason or intuition**.

The philosopher **G. E. Moore** is known for non-naturalism. He believed that:

- "Good" is a **simple idea** that cannot be explained using science or other facts.
- You just know it is good, without needing proof.

So, non-naturalism says:

- Moral facts are **real** (this is called **cognitivism**),
- But they are not physical or scientific.

🔶 10. What is Prescriptivism? (R. M. Hare's view)

Answer:

Prescriptivism is a theory in ethics developed by **R. M. Hare**. It says that **moral statements are not just opinions or emotions**, but they are **commands** that tell people how they should act.

For example:
When someone says, "Stealing is wrong," they are actually saying, "Do not steal." This is called a **prescription**.

Hare's theory has two main ideas:

1. **Prescriptivity** – Moral sentences give advice or instructions. They are like commands that guide our behavior.
2. **Universalizability** – If you say something is wrong, it must be wrong for **everyone in the same situation**, not just for one person.

So, prescriptivism means that moral language is a tool to **tell people what to do** in a way that can apply to everyone.

🔶 11. What is Multi-functionalism in ethics?

Answer:

Multi-functionalism, also called **moral functionalism**, is the idea that we should understand moral concepts like "right" or "good" by **what they do**, not by what they are made of.

This theory says:

- Just like the heart is defined by its function (pumping blood),
- Moral ideas like "right" or "good" are defined by their **role** in human life.

For example:

- "Rightness" helps people make good decisions.
- It motivates people to act and creates rules for living together in society.

This approach focuses on how moral language helps us **live better**, **cooperate**, and **judge actions**. It is influenced by **functionalism in psychology and philosophy**, which studies things based on their job or role.

🔶 12. Compare Bentham's and Mill's Utilitarianism.

Answer:

Utilitarianism is an ethical theory that says the best action is the one that brings the **most happiness and least pain** to the most people.

Both **Jeremy Bentham** and **John Stuart Mill** supported this idea, but they had different views:

✅ **Jeremy Bentham:**

- He focused on the **quantity of pleasure**.
- He believed **all pleasures are equal**, and more pleasure means a better action.
- Example: If eating 10 chocolates makes you happy, it is a good act.

✅ **John Stuart Mill:**

- He focused on the **quality of pleasure**.
- He believed some pleasures are **higher** than others.
- Mental pleasures (like learning or music) are better than physical ones (like eating).

So in summary:

Philosopher	Focus	View on Pleasure
Jeremy Bentham	Quantity of happiness	All pleasures are equal
John S. Mill	Quality of happiness	Some pleasures are better than others

Both agreed that **happiness is the goal**, but Mill believed that **intellectual and moral pleasures** are more valuable than physical pleasures.